



Transition Skills Resource Pack

AY 2026-27

Year 7

Name:

Year/Section

Arab Unity School, Dubai

Table of Contents

Topics	Marks obtained	Total Marks
Context Clues		
Speed Reading Techniques		
Author's Purpose		
Writing for an Audience		
Elements of Fiction		
Standard vs Non- Standard English		
Critical Thinking		

Context Clues

Context clues are hints found within a sentence, paragraph, or passage that a reader can use to understand the meanings of new or unfamiliar words.

There are different types of context clues.

I	Inference – the meaning is not given so you must use text clues	<i>Don't want to work with Ricardo, unless you want to hear him talk about himself. He is so arrogant.</i>
D	Definition – the meaning of the word is explained in the sentence	<i>Ricardo is so arrogant. He thinks he is more important than everyone else.</i>
E	Example – an example of the word is in the sentence or nearby sentences	<i>Ricardo is so arrogant. He is always bragging about how great he is at sports.</i>
A	Antonym – a word with opposite meaning is used in the sentence or near by sentences	<i>Ricardo is so arrogant. He needs to learn to be humble like his little brother Jose.</i>
S	Synonym – words with similar meaning are used in or near the sentence	<i>Ricardo is so arrogant, proud, self-centered, and over-bearing.</i>

Strong readers will always read the sentences surrounding the unknown word to look for clues.

Read the given passage.

Amelia was feeling quite *glum*. The rainy weather had *dashed* her plans for a picnic in the park. Stuck indoors, she decided to *delve* into her grandma's dusty *attic*, a treasure *trove* of forgotten *trinkets*. Cobwebs brushed against her face as she *unearthed* a *peculiar*, triangular object with smooth, polished sides. It felt surprisingly heavy for its size. Could it be a *petrified* (turned to stone) potato, a rare gem, or maybe even a piece of a *meteorite* (a rock from outer space)?

1. Can you use your own words to explain what "**glum**" means in the sentence?

2. What word in the passage has a similar meaning to "**dashed**"?

3. Based on the context, what is the opposite of "**delve**"?

4. What details in the passage help you understand what an "**attic**" might be?

5. The author gives us a few ideas of what the object might be. Can you think of another possibility based on the description?

Challenge Task

(5 Bonus Points)

Writing Application Task: The Mysterious Discovery

Imagine you're rummaging through your grandparents' attic, a place filled with forgotten treasures. Suddenly, you stumble upon a strange object unlike anything you've seen before.

Your Mission:

Write a story about this mysterious discovery. Use the new words in your writing and make sure the context clues you provide help your reader understand their meaning.

Remember:

- Use strong verbs and descriptive language to bring your story to life.
- Show, don't tell! Let the reader infer the meaning of the words you're using based on the context of your story.

Self-Assessment

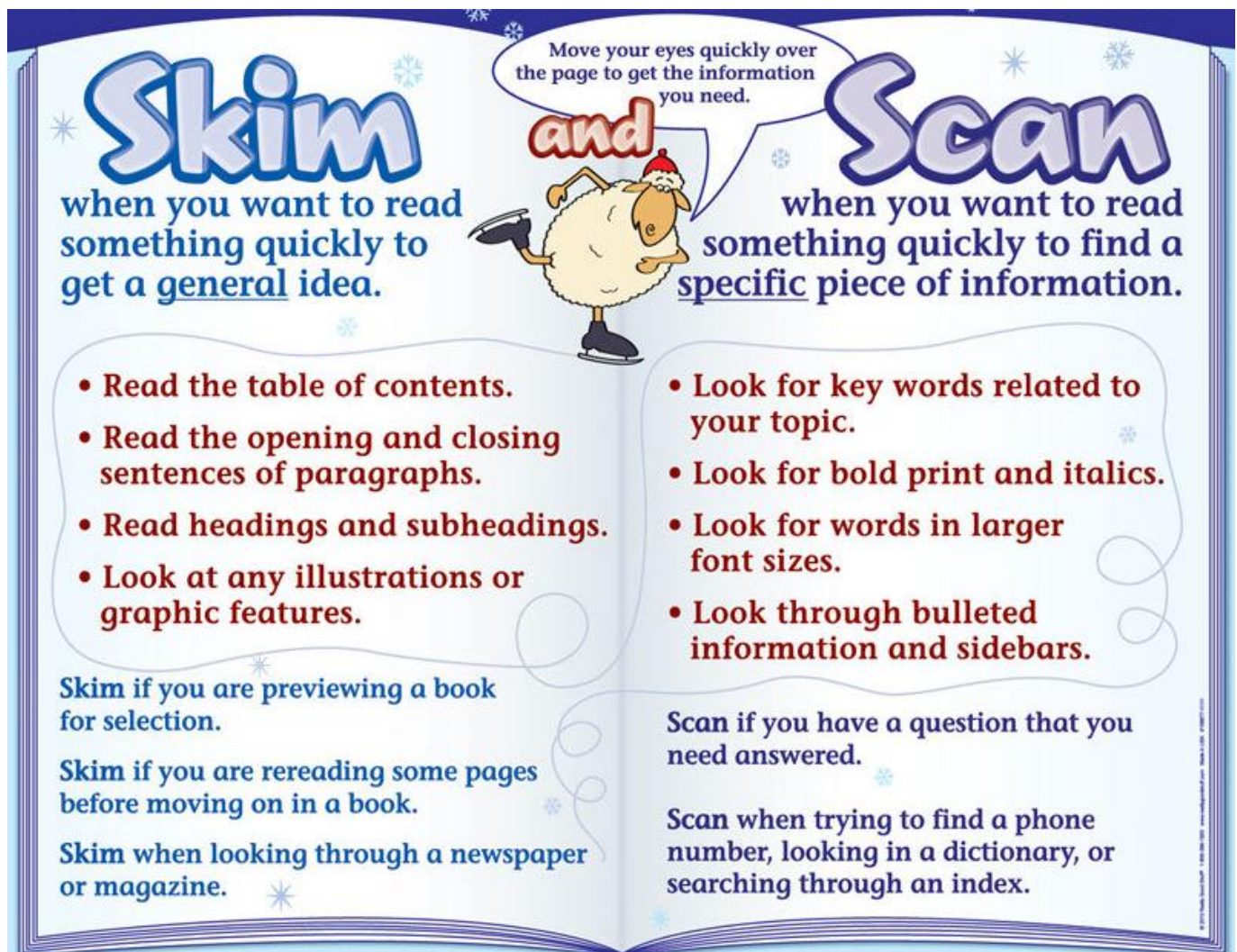
	Completely	Partially	Not at all
I can explain types of context clues using the acronym IDEAS	☐	☐	☐
I am able to identify different types of context clues.	☐	☐	☐
I am able to identify the meaning of all the unknown words using context clues.	☐	☐	☐
I am able to use most of the words in my own sentences.	☐	☐	☐

Speed Reading Techniques

Speed reading is the process of rapidly recognizing and absorbing phrases or sentences on a page all at once, rather than identifying individual words.

Skimming and **Scanning** are close friends when it comes to speed reading.

They are best together!



Read the given passage.

Taking Care of Our Oceans

Oceans provide a home to amazing creatures like fish, marine mammals, sea reptiles, and coral. Oceans are a renewable source of food and power for humans, and they generate most of the planet's oxygen by supporting sea plants like kelp, algae, and plankton. Oceans also help to regulate global temperatures.

Unfortunately, although humans receive many benefits from oceans, we are their biggest enemy, as consumers of energy and as polluters. Have you thought about how your daily activities affect the health of our oceans? Making simple changes in your routines can have a positive impact. Here are a few things you can do:

- Dispose of trash properly. Don't litter on land or in water!
- Recycle or reuse materials. Plastic items, including bottles, can be particularly harmful to oceans and to sea creatures. Use reusable food or drink containers. Buy or make reusable shopping bags.
- Reduce your "carbon footprint" (the amount of energy that you use from non-renewable sources). Bike, walk, carpool, or take public transportation to work and school. Use energy-efficient lights and appliances, and turn them off when no one is using them.
- Participate in a beach, river, or lake cleanup project. Or just pick up trash you see in these areas when you visit them.

Let's see if we can find the answer by skimming the text.

1. What kind of living things do oceans provide a home for?

2. What are two ways that oceans benefit humans?

3. What is the biggest threat to the health of our oceans?

4. What is one way to reduce your impact on the ocean?

5. Briefly, what are three ways you can help keep the oceans clean?

Let's hunt for the answer in the passage by scanning.

1. What does the term "carbon footprint" refer to in the passage?

2. According to the passage, what type of plant life helps generate most of the planet's oxygen?

3. What does the passage suggest people use instead of plastic bottles?

4. What are two examples of ways to reduce your carbon footprint according to the passage?

5. List two places mentioned in the passage where you can participate in a cleanup project.

Challenge Question (Bonus):

Can you find a specific action mentioned in the passage that helps regulate global temperatures?

Self-Assessment

	Completely	Partially	Not at all
I am able to identify the difference between skimming and scanning.	☐	☐	☐
I was able to apply the skill of skimming.	☐	☐	☐
I was able to apply the skill of scanning	☐	☐	☐

“

Author's Purpose

Authors have a specific reason for writing a text. Identifying the author's purpose helps readers understand the text and understand what the author wants the reader to learn.

”

Author's Purpose

An author's purpose is his or her reason for writing a text. Knowing the purpose helps you recognize the author's message.

If the author's purpose is to . . .

Persuade



readers to think or act in a certain way.

Inform



to share information about a topic.

Entertain



readers to enjoy a story.

How can you figure out the author's purpose?

FIRST...

think about the genre.

THEN...

ask questions about what you read and find answers.

Literary genres



each is read differently because they are written for different **purposes**, & are **organized** differently

FICTION

Purpose

To entertain with a story

When we read **FICTION** we look for...

- ★...main character
- ★...goals
- ★...problem
- ★...solution
- ★...outcome

NON-FICTION

Purpose

To inform or explain real life

When we read **NON-FICTION** we look for...

- ★...features
- ★...main ideas
- ★...important information
- ★...organization

POETRY

Purpose

To entertain with feelings & senses

When we read **POETRY** we look for...

- ★...form
- ★...speaker
- ★...topic
- ★...emotions
- ★...message

DRAMA

Purpose

comedy or tragedy

When we read **DRAMA** we look for...

- ★...dialogue
- ★...characters
- ★...performance
- ★...staging
- ★...audience

FICTION
sub genres

Fantasy

Horror

MYSTERY/THRILLER

Romance

Science Fiction

Western

We put it all together to **MAKE MEANING!!!**

Here are some short sections of different kinds of writing. Think about the author's purpose for writing each one.

1. What is the author's purpose for writing? (There may be more than one correct answer.)

We sailed along for days and days,
And had the very best of plays—
But Tom fell out and hurt his knee,
So there was no one left but me.

- a) to give us information
- b) to convince us to believe or do something
- c) to surprise us or make us laugh

2.

“My sons,” said the father, “if you are of one mind, and unite to help each other, you will be like the bundle of sticks, and no one will be able to harm you. But if you are divided among yourselves, you will be broken as easily as these sticks.”

The purpose of the author is to _____ because _____.

3.

Giant sloths the size of elephants once lived in many places on earth, including North America. Today, sloths can be found in the tropical forests of Central and South America. They eat leaves and berries. A sloth can stick its tongue out 12 inches.

The purpose of the author is to _____ because _____.

Make a Match

Each of the following sentences describes a type of text. Draw a line from each sentence to its match.

An article urging readers to eat their vegetables.

Inform

A fairy tale set in medieval times.

Persuade

A book that details how to build a birdhouse.

Entertain

Challenge Question (Bonus):

Beyond advertisements, can you identify another persuasive writing form with a rich history of influencing thought and action?

Self-Assessment

	Completely	Partially	Not at all
I am able to identify the main purpose of a written text.	☐	☐	☐
I am able to differentiate between similar purposes (e.g., inform vs. explain)	☐	☐	☐
I am able to explain how the author's purpose affects the content and style of the writing.	☐	☐	☐

Writing for an Audience

Effective writing assignments enable students to write fluently and purposefully for an audience.

R.A.F.T. S. can help you identify and incorporate the elements of an effective writing assignment.

R.A.F.T stands for

R	Role What is the writer's role? Critic, eye witness, staunch defender, reporter, etc.
A	Audience Who will read this writing? The teacher, other students, parents, community members, etc.
F	Format What is the best format for the writing? A poem, essay, letter, diary, newspaper article, etc.
T	Topic Who or what is the subject of the writing?
S	Strong Verbs What are the strong verbs used in the prompt/question?

EXAMPLE: You are Ulysses on you journey home from Troy after being gone for over ten years. Write a letter to your wife Penelope explaining why you won't make it home for dinner, AGAIN.

(role) (format) (audience) (strong verb) (topic)

Read the questions below to identify R.A.F.T.S.

1. You are a marine biologist who just witnessed a rare sea creature. Write a report for a scientific journal explaining the creature.
2. You are a contestant on a reality TV show and just won a major challenge. Write a diary entry about your experience.
3. You are a historical figure witnessing a major event. Write a letter to a friend describing what happened.
4. You are a chef who has just invented a revolutionary new dish. Write a press release to announce your creation.
5. You are a robot on a mission to explore a new planet. Write a log entry detailing your discoveries.
6. You are a time traveller who has just witnessed a pivotal moment in history. Write a journal entry about your experience, keeping your true identity a secret.
7. You are a young artist who has just sold your first painting at a prestigious gallery. Write a letter to your family describing your emotions.
8. You are a superhero who has just defeated a major villain. Write a report for your superhero team detailing the mission.
9. You are a superhero who has just defeated a major villain. Write a report for your superhero team detailing the mission.
10. You are an AI on a spaceship traveling for generations to a new habitable planet. You've recently discovered a message broadcasted from Earth, but it contradicts your programmed mission. Write a log entry detailing your internal conflict and the potential consequences of each choice.

Challenge Question (Bonus):

Pick up any one prompt to write your response. Use the learning tool for R.A.F.T.S to plan your writing.

R	Role
A	Audience
F	Format
T	Topic
S	Strong Verbs (I will use in my writing)

Sample Response: *Imagine you are one of the friends who found the last Unicorn. Write a letter to your family about your encounter.*

R	Role Friend
A	Audience My family
F	Format letter
T	Topic The Last Unicorn
S	Strong Verbs (I will use in my writing) Fictional, Fantasy, Prance, Eminate, Glow, Gleam, Whinny, Dash

[illegible]

[illegible]

Self-Assessment

	Completely	Partially	Not at all
Understanding			
I am able to identify the role I am taking on as a writer	☐	☐	☐
I am able to determine the appropriate audience for my writing	☐	☐	☐
I am able to choose the format that best suits my purpose	☐	☐	☐
I am able to identify the main topic I want to convey in my writing.	☐	☐	☐
I am able to select strong verbs that capture the essence of my role and the situation.	☐	☐	☐
Planning & Execution			
I am able to use the R.A.F.T.S. strategy to effectively plan my writing.	☐	☐	☐
I am able to write from the chosen role, adopting their voice and perspective.	☐	☐	☐
I am able to tailor my language and content to the specific audience.	☐	☐	☐
I am able to maintain a consistent format throughout my writing.	☐	☐	☐
I am able to develop the chosen topic with relevant details and explanations.	☐	☐	☐

Elements of Fiction

Fiction is make-believe, invented stories. They may be short stories, fables, or novels. Although writers may base a character on people they have met in real life, the characters and the experiences that the character faces in the story are not real.

Characters, setting, plot, conflict, point of view, and theme are six key elements for writing fiction. Stories are generally told in points of views.

Point of View

The Point of View tells us who is telling the



1 st Person	2 nd Person	3 rd Person
The story is told by one of the characters in the story.	The narrator will talk to the reader as if they are having a conversation.	The story is told by the narrator who is NOT a character in the story.
The narrator will refer to themselves as "I".	The narrator will refer to the readers as "you".	The narrator will refer to characters by name or with the words he, she, they.

3rd person can be:

Limited

The narrator knows only the thoughts and feelings of one person.

Omniscient

The narrator knows the thoughts and feelings of all the characters.

Elements of Fiction

All fiction stories have the same basic elements.

Plot

The plot refers to the events that take place in the story. Most events in a fictional story follow the story mountain.



Setting



The setting is where the story takes place. It helps the reader picture where the characters live and the location of the events.

Characters

The characters are the people in the story. There is usually a good character and a bad character in each story.



Conflict

All good fictional stories have a conflict. Usually it is a problem between two of the characters.

Theme

The theme is the overarching message or lesson the author is trying to teach the characters and the reader. It is usually a big idea.



Read the passage then identify the elements of fiction.

The rain hammered against the lighthouse windows, blurring the already murky view of the churning sea. Inside, Amelia, a young woman with eyes the color of the storm clouds, paced restlessly.

She clutched a worn leather-bound book, its pages filled with strange symbols. Amelia wasn't your typical lighthouse keeper; she was a descendant of a long line of weather witches, tasked with calming the storms that threatened the rocky coastline.

Tonight's storm was unlike any she'd seen before. The book, passed down through generations, offered no guidance for its fury. Panic gnawed at Amelia. If she couldn't calm the tempest, a nearby fishing vessel, the "Salty Siren," would be dashed against the jagged rocks.

Suddenly, an inscription on a forgotten page shimmered. It spoke of a hidden chamber within the lighthouse, unlocked only during the height of a storm. With a surge of hope, Amelia raced up the winding staircase, the book clutched tightly in her hand.

The chamber, dusty and cobwebbed, held a single object: a silver seashell. As Amelia held it close, a warmth spread through her, calming her racing heart.

Following the book's instructions, Amelia focused her will on the shell, channelling the storm's energy. Slowly, the winds began to lessen, the rain quieted to a drizzle. Relief washed over Amelia as she looked out at the calmer sea. The "Salty Siren" bobbed safely in the distance.

Exhausted but exhilarated, Amelia closed the book. The storm had tested her, but she had emerged stronger, a true protector of the coast.

Write a suitable title for the story.

Story Elements

Title:

Author:

Main Characters:

Supporting Characters:

Problem:

Words I Learned:

Setting:

Time

Place

Sequence of Events:

Beginning:

Middle:

End:

Solution:

Theme:

Rating:



Challenge Question (Bonus):

Choose any one prompt to plan your fictional narrative on the plot outline.

- ☐ **Dystopian Twist:** Everything seems normal in your town, until you discover a hidden truth about the way things work. How do you expose it?
- ☐ **The Time Capsule:** You dig up a time capsule from 20 years ago. What does it reveal about the past, and how does it impact your life?
- ☐ **The Mythical Creature Exchange Program:** A student from a world of mythical creatures comes to your school. What do you teach them about your world, and what do they teach you?
- ☐ **The Mysterious Message:** You receive a coded message from a stranger. Can you crack the code, and what does the message mean?
- ☐ **The Superpower Swap:** You wake up one day with your best friend's superpower (and vice versa). How do you learn to use each other's powers, and what adventures do you have?
- ☐ **The Interstellar Discovery:** On a school trip to a space station, you discover evidence of alien life. How do you react, and what does this mean for humanity?
- ☐ **Mystery at the Museum:** During a class trip, you discover a hidden room in the museum. What secrets does it hold?
- ☐ **The Wishing Machine:** You find a machine that can grant one wish. What do you wish for, and what are the consequences?
- ☐ **The Lost Library:** Hidden in the attic, you discover a dusty library filled with magical books. What happens when you open one?
- ☐ **The Hidden Power:** You discover you have a hidden power you never knew about. How do you learn to control it, and how does it change your life?




Story's Title ★

Write the story's title here.

Name _____
 Period ____

Climax ★
 The most suspenseful moment

Event #3

Event #1

Event #2

Event #2

Event #1

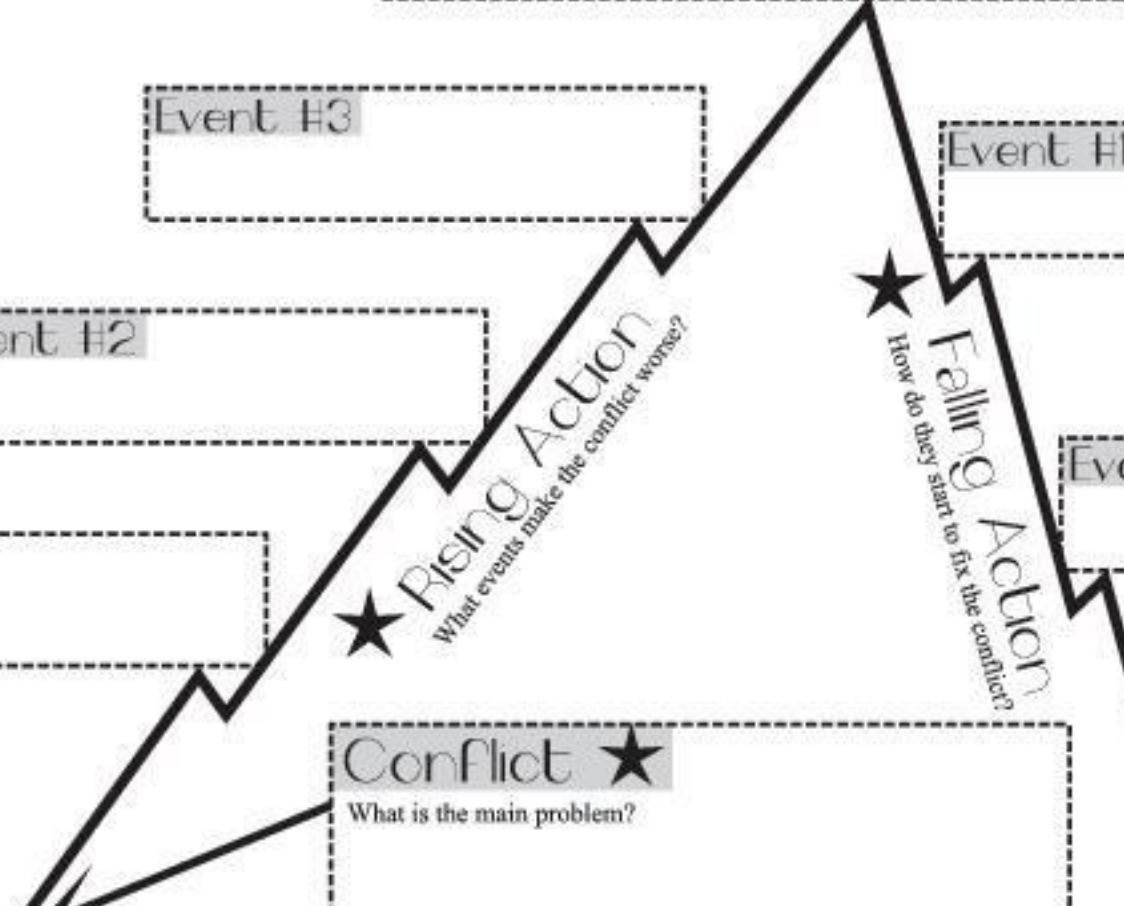
Conflict ★
 What is the main problem?

Characters (who / background)

Setting (where/when)

Exposition ★

Resolution ★
 How is the main conflict resolved?



Rising Action ★
 What events make the conflict worse?

Falling Action ★
 How do they start to fix the conflict?

Self-Assessment

	Completely	Partially	Not at all
Understanding			
I am able to identify the basic elements of fiction, such as characters, setting, plot, conflict, theme, and point of view.	☐	☐	☐
I am able to analyze the characters' motivations, goals, and actions within the story.	☐	☐	☐
I am able explain the theme or central message of a story and how it's conveyed through plot and characters.	☐	☐	☐
I am able to identify the main point of view used in a story.			
I am able to identify the purpose behind an author's choice of point of view (e.g., building suspense, creating emotional connection).			
Planning & Execution			
I am able to brainstorm ideas for characters, settings, and conflicts for my own fictional stories.	☐	☐	☐
I am able to create a basic plot outline that identifies the key events of the story.	☐	☐	☐

Standard English and Non-Standard English

Standard English is the form of English that is taught around the world and understood by all speakers of the language.

Non-standard English is the informal version of the language, which can change depending on where it is being spoken.

	Standard English	Non-standard English
When it is used?	Standard English is used in formal settings , for example when we talk or write to people we don't know well, such as doctors or head teachers. We do this to show them respect or to make a good impression .	We use non-standard English in informal settings , when we are more relaxed and with people we know well, such as family or friends.
Settings	We often use standard, formal English in school, work or writing letters .	When writing things like text messages, emails, postcards or letters to friends and family , we are much more likely to use non-standard, informal English.
Uses	Formal or polite style or tone	Informal or friendly tone
	Standard grammar	Mostly standard grammar but some variations
	Longer words and phrases	Simpler words and phrases
	Fewer contracted words, like you're and we'd	Lots of contracted words
	No slang	Lots of slang
	Fewer abbreviations	Lots of abbreviations, like asap (as soon as possible) or gonna (going to)

Spot the Slang!

Can you decipher the meaning of the slang words and rewrite the sentences in standard English?

1. My phone is acting up again!

2. That movie was totally lit!

3. I gotta bounce, gotta meet my friends.

4. My teacher threw some major shade at my presentation.

5. I'm feeling super hangry after skipping lunch.

6. That test was a total brain drain!

7. My friend is always on fleek with her fashion choices.

8. We're planning to ditch school and go to the beach.

Challenge Question (Bonus):

Write a short paragraph (5-7 sentences) about your favourite hobby. Use standard English and avoid slang.

This image shows a blank sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and extend across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

Self-Assessment

	Completely	Partially	Not at all
Understanding			
I am able to explain the difference between standard and non- standard English	☐	☐	☐
I am able to differentiate between the tones associated with Standard and Non-Standard English	☐	☐	☐
I am able identify the grammatical differences between Standard and Non-Standard English	☐	☐	☐

Critical thinking: How Do You Hide an Elephant?

You probably can't hide an elephant in your room, but you can hide one in a sentence. Let's start small. Can you find the goat that is hiding in the sentence below?

Lisa will go at dinner time.

The two words *go at* spell goat when you put them together.

Now, find these animals in the sentences below.

Underline the letters that spell the animal names.

ape	deer	horse	rat
kitten	owl	dog	bear
lamb	hen	pony	mice



1. Go fish or see what we have to eat in the refrigerator.
2. Be artistic and paint a picture for me.
3. She needs a new cover for her book.
4. Tom iced the cake for the birthday party.
5. Do girls like soccer or baseball?
6. Ms. Dee read a book to the class.
7. What a big bowl of noodles you have!
8. Hop on your bicycle and let's go for a ride.
9. Jess took a peek into the package.
10. "Slam bam!" the ball hit the rim with a crash!
11. Jay did kick it ten times in row.
12. Please have dinner at my house on Monday.

Don't Forget the Elephant!

Now about that elephant. Write a sentence that hides an elephant. Then switch papers with a friend and see if you can find one another's elephants.
